people in the country. Under Ratan's leadership, Tata Sons committed Rs 1,000 crore to Covid-19 relief measures and Tata Trusts, Rs 500 crore. It remains the largest amount pledged by a corporate house and its philanthropic arm since the outbreak of the disease in India. And this was during the first wave. Later, group companies like TCS and Tata Steel added contributions worth nearly Rs 1,000 crore. The 'group overall has made a commitment and spent to the order of Rs 2,500 crore approximately', says N. Chandrasekaran.

Speaking amidst one of the toughest challenges that the human race has faced, Ratan said, 'The current situation in India and across the world is of grave concern and needs immediate action. Tata Trusts and the Tata Group's companies have in the past risen to the needs of the nation. At this moment, the need of the hour is greater than any other time.'

What defines the Tatas' crisis response is not merely the scale of its financial commitment towards the fight against Covid-19, but also its unwavering and continued emphasis on taking forward its commitment to medical philanthropy. The Tatas donated twenty ambulances and ventilators and committed Rs 10 crore to the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation to further plasma trials. Committing another technological system to the cause, a bridgital system is being readied to bring patients and doctors on one platform for testing, treatment and follow-ups. Banmali Agrawala of Tata Sons, the man at the helm of the group's special Covid-19 task force, says that 'the attitude, the approach and the intellectual contribution in terms of finding a solution' sets them miles apart from their peers.

Together, Tata companies and Tata Trusts have been discharging their corporate social responsibility (CSR) in myriad ways for more than a century before it was mandated in the country in 2014. For the founder, successive heads of both Tata Sons and Tata Trusts, and Ratan in particular, businesses were and are meant to fulfil social needs. For Ratan, if anything, the emphasis is more expansive—to start new programmes, contribute to and complement existing ones to address the problems of the marginalized sections of the society. As he says, large businesses must orient themselves to 'serve a social need also in addition to just serving a business need'.

Committing Personal Wealth